

WORKSHEET

Is My Child Eligible? Pre-Evaluation Checklist

Use this checklist before you request a special education evaluation. You do not need to check every item. This is a tool to help you organize your thinking and communicate clearly with the school.

Part 1: Educational Impact

Check any that describe your child's experience at school:

- ☐ My child struggles to keep up with grade-level academic work.
- ☐ My child has difficulty reading, writing, or completing math at grade level.
- ☐ My child struggles to communicate or be understood by peers and teachers.
- ☐ My child has behavioral or emotional challenges that interfere with learning.
- ☐ My child has difficulty with attention, focus, or organization.
- ☐ My child is socially isolated or has difficulty with peer relationships.
- ☐ My child avoids school, complains of anxiety, or has frequent absences.
- ☐ My child has already received a diagnosis from a doctor or private evaluator.
- ☐ My child receives outside tutoring or therapy but still struggles at school.

Part 2: School History

Question	Your Notes
Has the school expressed concerns about your child?	
Has your child received tutoring, support groups, or extra services?	
Has your child ever been held back or had a grade modification?	
Has the school suggested testing or evaluation before?	
Does your child currently have a 504 Plan?	
Have you shared any private reports or diagnoses with the school?	

Part 3: Your Formal Request

Under IDEA, you have the right to request a special education evaluation in writing at any time. The school must respond within a specific timeline (typically 15 school days to respond and 60 calendar days to complete the evaluation, though timelines vary by state).

Your written request should include:

- Your child's full name and date of birth

- The specific areas of concern (academic, behavioral, social, speech, etc.)
- Why you believe a disability may be affecting your child's education
- Any evaluations, diagnoses, or reports you have from outside professionals
- A request for evaluation in all areas of suspected disability
- Your contact information and preferred method of communication

IMPORTANT: Submit your request in writing. Email with read receipt is best. Keep a dated copy. The school's response timeline begins from the date they receive your request.

Next Steps

After you submit your request:

- The school must respond, typically within 15 school days, to accept or decline the evaluation request.
- If they agree to evaluate, they will send you a consent form. Read it carefully before signing.
- If they decline, they must provide Prior Written Notice explaining why in writing.
- If you disagree with their decision to decline, you can file a state complaint or request due process.

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Free family resource. Share with any family who needs it.